

Beli: Verified Visit Reviews

Product Requirements Document | July 8, 2026 | POC: Anvitha Abbagani

Objective

Users leave Beli to complete their decision, switching to Google Maps, Yelp, and Instagram before choosing a restaurant. This isn't just a layout problem, it's a content-ownership problem: Beli doesn't yet generate enough of its own trusted review content to be the final word on a restaurant. 100% of interviewed users said they trust reviews on other platforms more than Beli's. This phase closes that gap directly.

The Problem

Problem	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE
P1: Can't make final decisions in-app	5	4	4	4	20
P2: Info not structured around decisions	5	3	4	3	20
P3: Beli doesn't own trusted reviews	5	5	5	5	25

P3 is the priority. It's the only problem backed by a direct trust measurement: 100% of interviewed users trust reviews on other platforms more than Beli's. Structured Card work (price, menu, commute) is already built and stays as is; this phase's entire focus is making Beli's reviews trustworthy enough that users stop leaving to double-check them elsewhere.

Who This Is For

Primary: Intent-Driven Diner – "Help me quickly decide without switching apps." Starts on Beli, switches elsewhere for validation.

Secondary: Passive Food Logger – "I want to track experiences, but not if it feels like work." Beli's biggest untapped review source; easier logging closes much of the supply gap.

Tertiary: Local Expert / Early Reviewer – "I want credit for finding it first." Motivated by status and completeness. This phase offers a Verified Reviewer badge at 15 reviews; most convertible into Beli's owned review supply.

The Solution: Verified Visit Reviews

Beli already has the beginning of a verification system, it just isn't finished. 70% of users noticed "Places you may have been" (Google Calendar-based visit detection), and the review flow already asks for photos and notes. But it only catches visits with a calendar event, and one of its fields (Add Labels) is dead weight, as 100% of users didn't know it existed.

This phase strengthens what exists and adds two small pieces:

- **Receipt upload** as a second verification method alongside calendar detection, for walk-ins and visits that never synced to a calendar.
- **Proof of Visit** replaces the unused Add Labels field, reflecting the verification method used.
- **A completeness nudge** (optional, skippable) encouraging a photo or note if left blank.
- **A verified reviewer badge** at 15 verified reviews, with visible progress, giving users a reason to keep submitting verified content.

Verification is fully optional. Standard, unverified logging stays exactly as easy as it is today, this phase adds a stronger path, it doesn't gate the existing one. Full solution scoring and rationale in Appendix B. A working prototype is linked in Appendix C.

How We'll Know It's Working

Key Metric: Verified Review Rate – % of reviews submitted that are verified (calendar or receipt).

At 30 days, we watch Verification Completion Rate, where people start verification and finish it. At 60 days, Verified Review Rate should rise without Standard Log Rate collapsing, meaning verification is being adopted without adding friction elsewhere. At 90 days, Decision Action Rate is the number for stakeholders: if verified reviews are moving people to actually decide within Beli, the hypothesis holds. Full metrics table in Appendix A.

Timeline

Task	Date
Leadership approval	Day 0
Design ready	+7 days
Prototype testing	+10 days
Development starts	+14 days
Beta launch	+30 days

Top Risks

- **Calendar detection alone misses too many visits.** Mitigated by receipt upload as an equally visible path.
- **Unclear or fake receipts undermine the badge's credibility.** Mitigated by flagging unreadable receipts as unverified rather than accepting them; legibility standard still being defined.
- **Verification could add friction to logging overall.** Mitigated by keeping verification fully optional and tracking Standard Log Rate as a guardrail.

Full risk table in Appendix E.

What's Next

Phase 2 builds reputation sorting, cuisine badges, and shareable "Review Unlocked" cards, once verified reviews exist to build on. **Phase 3** reintroduces an AI restaurant summary, but only once a restaurant has enough verified reviews to summarize honestly. The Creator/Ambassador Program is on hold pending legal review of disclosure requirements. Full detail in Appendix F.

Appendix

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A. Evidence & Full Metrics

Problems

Problem 1: Users cannot make final decisions within Beli

Job to be Done: "When I'm choosing where to eat, I want to quickly evaluate my options so I can confidently make a decision."

Pain Points:

- 100% of surveyed users switch to at least one other app before making a final decision
- Information is fragmented (menu, price, reviews, ambiance)
- Difficult to compare options quickly

Why it Matters: Beli is used for discovery but fails at decision-making, the most critical step, leading to drop-offs before conversion

Problem 2: Information is not structured around decision needs

Job to be Done: "Help me filter and evaluate places based on what actually matters to me"

Pain Points:

- Missing or inconsistent information (e.g., price)
- Cannot filter effectively by vibe, occasion, or constraints
- Too many options create decision fatigue

Why it Matters: Unstructured data slows decision-making and reduces user trust in the platform

Problem 3: Beli does not yet own the reviews users trust most

Job to be Done: "Help me capture my dining experience effortlessly and accurately, and give me confidence that other people's reviews on Beli are worth trusting"

Pain Points:

- Users forget dish names and details when logging later, so reviews that do get written are often shallow or delayed
- 84.6% of users don't log meals immediately, and logging feels time-consuming
- Even when users trust Beli for social discovery ("people my age"), they still default to Zomato for food and reviews and Instagram for photos — Beli isn't yet a primary source of decision-grade content
- Beli cannot repurpose Google's or Zomato's review content as its own; API terms restrict caching and require attribution, meaning any long-term trust advantage has to come from Beli's own review supply

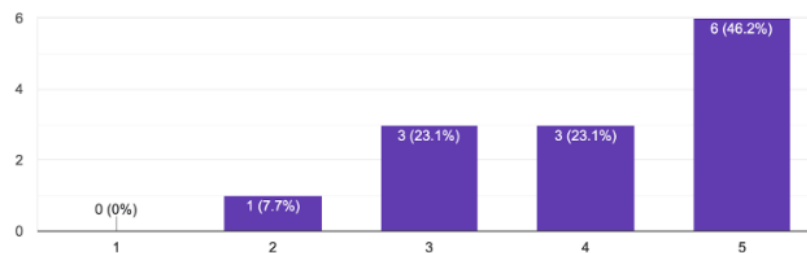
Why it Matters: Low content creation reduces recommendation quality, weakens trust in Beli's reviews specifically, and is the root cause behind why users still leave Beli to validate a decision elsewhere. This problem is upstream of Problem 1 — if Beli doesn't generate trustworthy reviews, no amount of restructuring existing information will fully close the app-switching gap.

Evidence

Insight 1: Users cannot rely on Beli for final decisions

- **Survey Insights:**
 - 100% of users switch to other apps before deciding

Do you switch to other apps after using Beli before making a final decision? 1: Never; 5: Always
13 responses

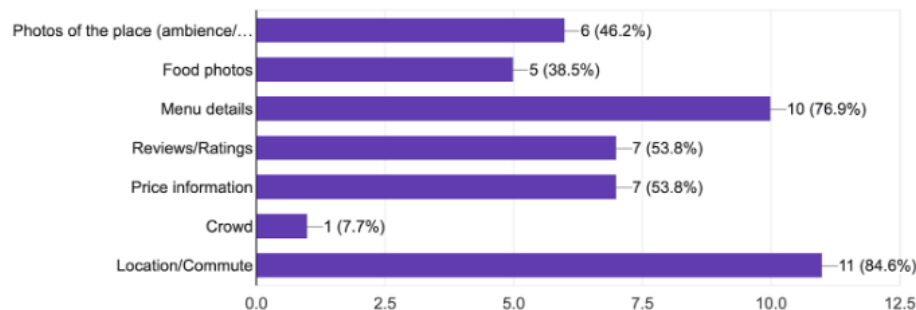


- **Interview Insights:**
 - 100% of interviewed users said they trust reviews on alternative platforms (Google, Zomato, Yelp) more than reviews on Beli
 - Users rely on multiple platforms for different needs:
 - Photos → Instagram & TikTok
 - Menu & reviews → Zomato
 - Location → Google Maps
 - “I use Google for photos, Zomato for food, Beli for people my age”
 - “I wish everything was consolidated in one platform”

Insight 2: Users need structured, decision-ready information

- **Survey Insights:**
 - Top needs when switching apps:
 - Location/commute (84.6%)
 - Menu details (76.9%)
 - Reviews and price (53.8%)

What do you usually look for when switching to another app? (Select up to 3)
13 responses

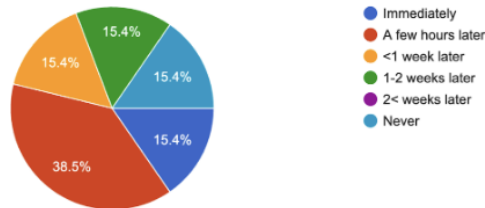


- **Interview Insights:**
 - “No price available”
 - “I can’t filter by what actually matters (vibe, price, occasion)”

Insight 3: Logging is delayed and inaccurate

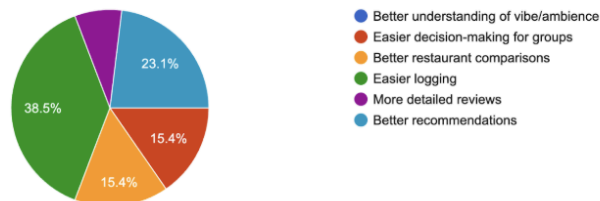
- 84.6% of users do not log meals immediately

How long after do you log meals?
13 responses



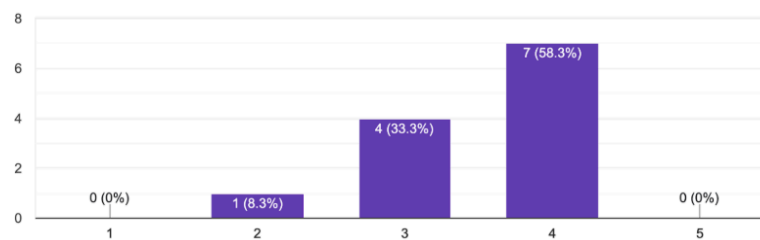
- 38.5% want easier logging

If Beli could improve ONE thing, what would you choose?
13 responses



- 100% report forgetting details when logging later

When logging after a delay, how accurate do you feel your memory is?
12 responses



This delay compounds beyond the individual user: a review written from memory 1-2 weeks later is typically shorter, less specific, and less useful to other diners than one captured in the moment, directly limiting the depth and reliability of Beli's own review content.

Key Insight: Users trust Beli for social discovery, but not for the reviews that drive a final decision; 100% of interviewees said they trust reviews on other platforms more than Beli's, and switch apps to validate before deciding.

Measuring Success

Associated OKR/Goal

Goal: Make Beli a trusted source of reviews, not just a discovery tool users leave to validate elsewhere

Key Result: Increase the % of reviews submitted on Beli that are verified (calendar match or receipt), and increase the % of users taking a decision action after viewing a restaurant page

Metric Type	Metric Name	Definition	Why it Matters
Key Metric	Verified Review Rate	% of total reviews submitted that are verified (calendar or receipt)	Measures whether Beli is actually building trusted content, not just any content
Secondary	Verification Completion Rate	% of users who start verification (tap Calendar or Upload Receipt) and complete it	Shows whether the verification flow itself is usable, not just available
Secondary	Verification Method Split	% of verified reviews from Calendar match vs. Receipt upload	Shows which verification path users actually rely on, informs where to invest further
Secondary	Decision Action Rate	% of users who click Go / Book / Call / Save after viewing a restaurant page	Measures whether increased review trust translates into more decisions made within Beli

Guardrail Metrics

Metric Type	Metric Name	Definition	Why it Matters
Guardrail	Verification Failed Rate	% of receipt upload attempts that fail or are flagged unreadable	High failure rate signals the receipt flow is too strict or poorly understood
Guardrail	Standard Log Rate	% of reviews submitted without verification	A sharp drop could mean verification is being pushed too hard and adding friction to logging overall
Guardrail	Return-to-Search Rate	% of users going back to search after viewing a restaurant	Signals users still can't decide, even with verified reviews present

30/60/90 Day Expectations

At 30 days, the primary signal is Verification Completion Rate. If users are seeing the Verify Your Visit module but not completing it, either the flow is too effortful or the value isn't clear. This is the earliest and cheapest problem to catch, before drawing conclusions about whether verified reviews actually change trust or decision behavior downstream.

At 60 days, the focus shifts to Verified Review Rate and Standard Log Rate together. A rising Verified Review Rate without a collapsing Standard Log Rate means verification is being adopted without adding friction to logging overall, the outcome this phase is designed for. If Verified Review Rate stays flat, verification isn't gaining traction even where it's available, which points to a motivation or visibility problem, not a technical one.

By 90 days, Decision Action Rate is the number brought to stakeholders. If it shows a statistically significant lift over baseline that connects verified reviews directly to the trust gap identified in Problem 3, users are deciding within Beli because the content is more credible, not just better organized. If it doesn't move, the next iteration needs to

look at whether verified reviews are prominent enough on the page, or whether volume is still too low to matter, rather than concluding trust isn't the right lever at all.

B. Solution Prioritization: RICE

What Beli already has, and why it isn't enough

Beli already has the beginning of a verification system, it just isn't being used as one, and parts of the existing flow aren't landing with users at all.

Reservation based check in ("Places you may have been") exists and is partially working. It works by reading Google Calendar for reservation-like events, not by tracking bookings made through Beli itself. 70% of users said they noticed this feature. That's a real foundation, most users are aware Beli is trying to confirm visits. But it only covers visits that show up as a calendar event. Someone who reserved without it syncing to their calendar, didn't grant calendar access, or simply walked in isn't captured at all. Given how many restaurant visits don't generate a calendar event in the first place, this is likely a large share of total visits.

The post visit review flow already asks for the right things, but one part is dead weight. The current flow includes Add Labels, Add Notes, Add Photos, and Add Visit Date. 100% of users said they didn't know Add Labels existed. A field nobody notices doesn't help credibility, it's a wasted step in a flow that's otherwise close to what's needed.

Friend tagging already exists, but isn't used for anything beyond social display. Who Did You Go With is already part of the review flow. It currently shows up as metadata, not as a form of confirmation.

The pattern here isn't "Beli has nothing," it's "Beli built the pieces and didn't finish connecting them to trust." That's the gap this phase closes.

Solutions Prioritization: RICE

Solution	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE
Verified Visit Reviews	5	4	5	4	25
Review completeness nudge	4	2	3	1	24
Reputation based review sorting	4	3	3	3	12
Frequent Reviewers achievements section	4	2	3	2	12
Review Map and cuisine badges	3	3	3	3	9
Review Unlocked share cards	3	2	3	2	9
Friend-verified visits	3	2	3	3	6
Creator or Ambassador Program	2	3	2	4	3

The prioritized solution: Verified Visit Reviews

Rather than building a new system, this phase strengthens two things that already exist and adds two new additions:

Strengthen: visit detection. Calendar based detection remains the primary method, unchanged. Add receipt upload as a second, equally valid verification method for any visit that doesn't produce a calendar event, walk ins, reservations that didn't sync, or users without calendar access connected. This closes the gap left by relying on Google Calendar alone, without requiring unverifiable self-reported claims.

Strengthen: the review flow itself. Replace Add Labels, the unused field, with Proof of Visit, occupying the same position and reflecting whichever verification method (calendar or receipt) was already completed. This turns an ignored step into the one that actually establishes trust.

Unchanged: friend tagging. Who Did You Go With stays exactly as it exists today, social metadata shown alongside a review. It is not used as a verification signal in this phase; only calendar match or receipt upload produce a verified review.

Add: a visible progress goal. An x/15 counter toward a verified reviewer badge, so users have a reason to keep submitting verified reviews rather than stopping after one.

Why this approach, explicitly

Building on existing features instead of new ones matters for a specific reason, not just efficiency. Users already partially trust and use the check-in and review flow, 70% noticed check-in, the flow itself already asks for photos and notes. The problem isn't that users are unfamiliar with a verification concept, it's that Beli didn't push the existing flow far enough to make it mean something, and the calendar based detection alone misses a meaningful share of real visits. That's a smaller, safer bet than introducing a brand new verification system users have never seen before.

Alongside the verification build, a quick UI cleanup was made to the restaurant page itself, tightening CTA visibility and making the overall layout more structured. This wasn't scoped as a separate initiative or scored in the RICE table below, it's a light pass on existing screens to support the verification flow sitting on top of it, not a redesign of the information architecture. The original Structured Card layout work (price, menu, occasion tags, commute) remains as already built, this cleanup just sharpens what was already there.

Out of scope for this phase

AI summary, moved to Future Steps, gated behind restaurants reaching a verified review threshold. Reputation sorting, review map badges, and share cards stay in backlog until Verified Visit Reviews ships. Creator or Ambassador Program stays in Future Steps.

Considered and rejected

Requiring a photo or note to complete verification: Would add friction to the exact behavior this phase is trying to increase. Verification and completeness stay separate, verification proves the visit, the completeness nudge (optional) improves the content.

Cross-referencing a user's Google Maps search history: No public API grants access to this. Not pursued in this or future phases.

GPS dwell-time tracking as a verification method: Requires background location access, which most users decline, and is unreliable as a primary method for that reason.

Friend tagging or friend confirmation as a verification signal. Considered two versions of this: weighting existing friend tags as a secondary trust signal, and a more active flow where a tagged friend confirms a shared visit. Rejected both, for the same reason, confirmation between two users isn't independently checkable, so two friends

could confirm a visit that never happened. Friend tagging stays as it exists today, social metadata only, not a verification input.

C. Product Flow

Customer Journey

Stage 1: Discovery

User opens Beli and searches for a restaurant, or sees "Places you may have been," based on Google Calendar, listed on the search page itself. Taps a restaurant (e.g., Spicy Moon West Village).

Stage 2: Evaluation

User lands on the restaurant page and scans price, location, tags, and existing content. Unchanged this phase.

Stage 3: Decision

User taps Go, Book, Call, or Save. Unchanged this phase.

Stage 4: Visit Detection

Below the CTA row, a "Verify Your Visit" module shows two options:

- Google Calendar, auto-detected and matched if a calendar event exists
- Upload a receipt, for visits without a calendar match

If a calendar match exists, tapping it verifies instantly, a confirmation banner appears ("Visit verified via Google Calendar match!"), and the module updates to show Verified status.

This step is optional. A user can skip it entirely and log a standard review with no verification, same as today.

Stage 5: New Review

Triggered from Verify Your Visit or independently as a standard log. The review modal shows:

- How was it (liked it / it was fine / didn't like it)
- Who did you go with (friend tags)
- Proof of Visit (optional). If the user is already verified via calendar in Stage 4, this shows as already verified with a Remove option. If not, it offers a receipt upload.
- Add notes, Add favorite dishes, Add photos (separate from Proof of Visit), Add visit date, Stealth mode

Stage 6: Completeness Check

If notes or photos are left blank at submission, a nudge appears: "Add a photo or note to help others trust your review?" with Add Now and Skip options. Skip proceeds directly to submission.

Stage 7: Submitted

Review saved. If verified, counts toward the user's progress indicator (x/15) shown on their profile.

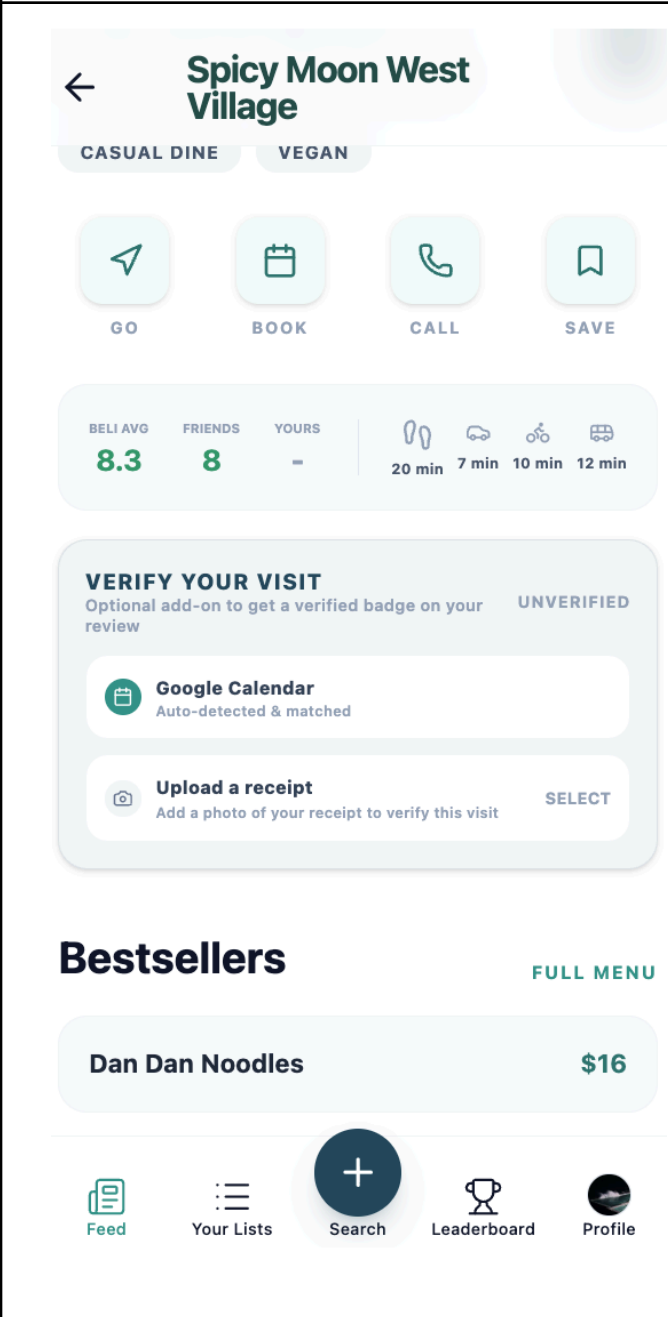
Wireframes and Flow Diagrams

The four screens below capture the core flow: starting the module, completing verification, the review reflecting that verification, and the badge earned. The full click-through, including the calendar/receipt alternate paths and additional screens, is available in the linked prototype.

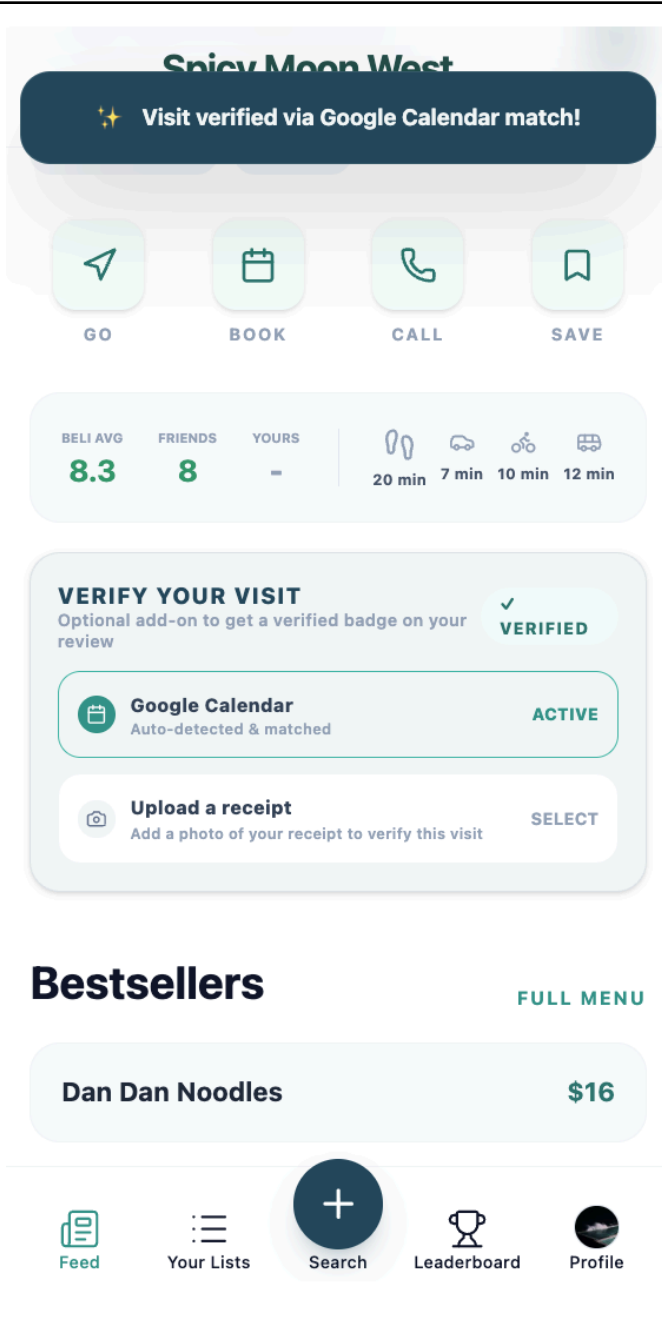
Prototype Link	
Screen 1: Restaurant page, unverified state. Verify Your Visit	Screen 2: Verify Your Visit, verified state. Calendar match

module shown below the CTA row, with Google Calendar and receipt upload both available, neither yet completed.

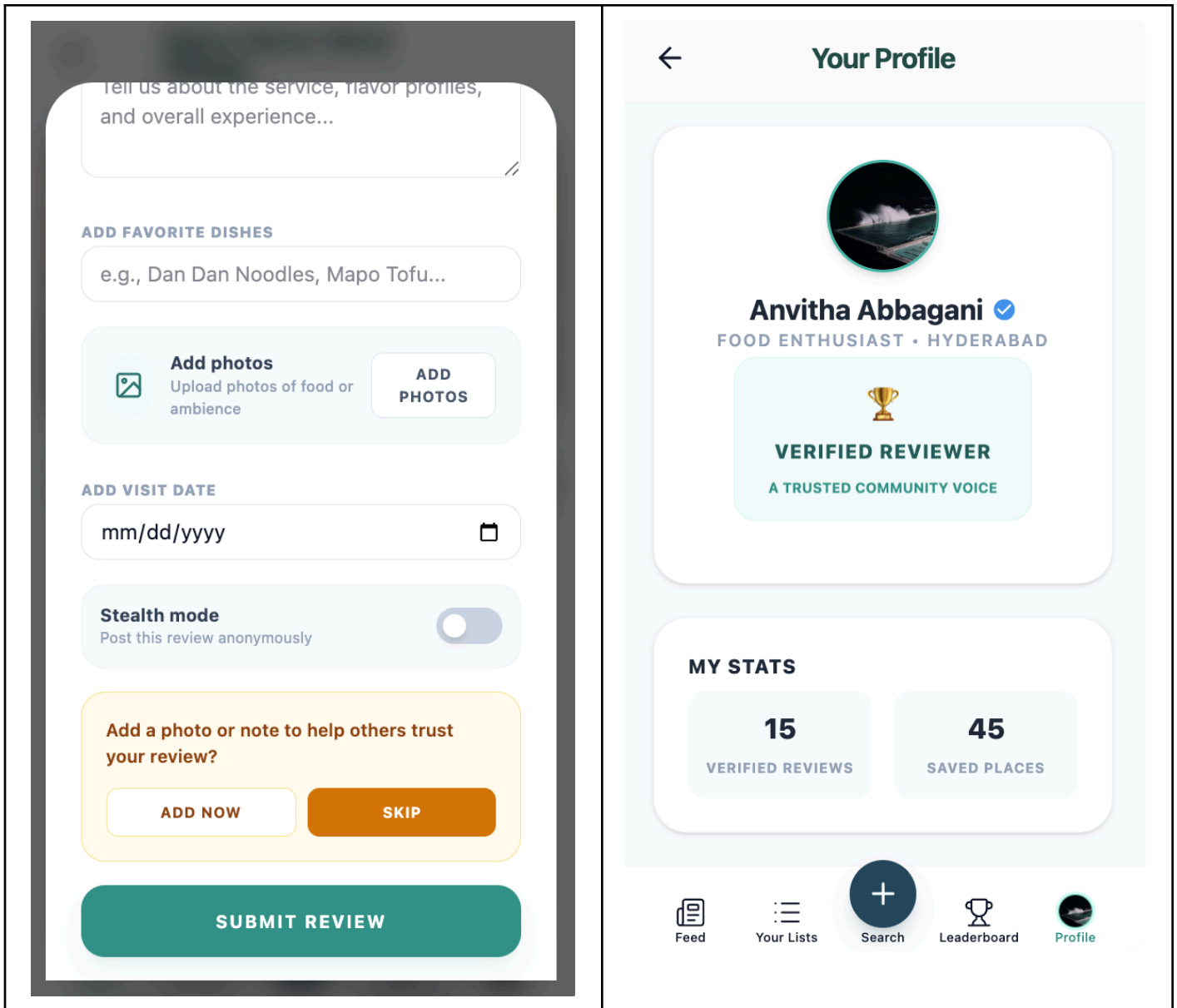
confirmed, in-app confirmation banner shown ("Visit verified via Google Calendar match!").



Screen 3: New Review, reflecting prior verification. Proof of Visit shows as already verified with a Remove option, the review flow does not ask for proof a second time.



Screen 4: Verified Reviewer badge earned. Profile shows 15/15 verified reviews and the Verified Reviewer badge.



D. User Stories, Acceptance Criteria, Edge Cases

User Stories

- As an intent-driven diner deciding between two options with friends, I want to see price per person, occasion fit, and a menu highlight in one view so I can make a confident recommendation without opening Google Maps or Yelp.
- As a diner who has decided where to eat, I want navigation, reservation, and call CTAs accessible above the fold so the transition from decision to action requires no additional steps.
- As a diner, I want an easy way to verify a real visit, whether through a calendar match or a receipt, so my review carries more trust without extra effort.

- As a diner who wants to log a quick review, I want verification to stay optional, so logging isn't harder than it is today.
- As a diner writing a review, I want a gentle nudge if I skip a photo or note, without being blocked from submitting.
- As a diner building a reputation on Beli, I want to see my progress toward a verified reviewer badge, so I have a reason to keep submitting verified reviews.
- As a diner reading reviews on a restaurant page, I want to know which reviews came from a verified visit, so I know which ones to trust.

User Acceptance Criteria

- Restaurant page displays price per person, menu highlights, ratings and reviews, photos, occasion tags, location and commute.
- CTA buttons (Go, Book, Call, Save) are visible above the fold and functional.
- Verification (calendar match or receipt) is optional and never blocks the standard review flow.
- The review modal reflects any verification already completed, it does not prompt for proof twice.
- Only a verified review (calendar or receipt) counts toward the x/15 badge progress. Standard logs do not.
- If notes or photos are blank at submission, a one-time nudge appears with a Skip option that does not block submission.
- The profile screen shows verified review progress and updates to a Verified Reviewer badge at 15.

Edge Cases

- Missing data (no menu or price available).
 - Show "Data unavailable" and fallback recommendations.
- Receipt doesn't clearly show a restaurant name or date.
 - Flag as unverified. Exact detection logic is an open engineering question.
- No calendar access granted.
 - Show only the receipt option, not a Calendar option that can never activate.
- User dismisses the completeness nudge.
 - Submission proceeds without notes or photos.
- Two unrelated users submit proof for the same restaurant and date.
 - No cross-checking exists. Open risk, not solved in this phase.

E. Key Event Tracking Sheet & Assumptions/Risks

Key Event Tracking Sheet

Event Name	Description	Trigger	Supports
Restaurant Page Viewed	User lands on restaurant page	Page load	Decision Action Rate, Return-to-Search Rate (denominator)
CTA Clicked	User taps Go / Book / Call / Save	Button click	Decision Action Rate
Return to Search	User goes back to search after viewing a restaurant	Back action	Return-to-Search Rate
Verification Started	User taps Calendar or Receipt option (property: method)	Button click	Verification Completion Rate (denominator)

Verification Completed	Visit verified, calendar or receipt (property: method)	System confirmation	Verification Completion Rate, Verified Review Rate, Verification Method Split
Verification Failed	Receipt rejected or unreadable	System response	Verification Failed Rate
Review Submitted	Review saved (property: verified true/false)	Button click	Verified Review Rate, Standard Log Rate
Badge Threshold Reached	User hits 15 verified reviews	System trigger	Not a named metric, but the core feature milestone, worth keeping

Assumptions & Risks

Assumption	Risk	Mitigation	Threshold to Act	Detection Metric
Users will use calendar-based verification when available	Low calendar connection or match rate limits verified review volume	Offer receipt upload as an equally visible alternative, not a fallback buried behind calendar	If calendar verification accounts for <30% of verified reviews at 30 days, prioritize improving receipt flow	Verification Method Split
Receipt uploads can be reasonably validated	Users upload unclear or unrelated photos, false verifications reduce trust in the badge itself	Flag unreadable receipts as unverified rather than accepting them; define minimum legibility checks before launch	If Verification Failed rate exceeds 20% of receipt attempts, revisit upload requirements or add manual review	Verification Failed Rate
Making verification optional won't reduce standard logging	Users ignore verification entirely, review supply doesn't shift toward trusted content	Track verified vs. unverified review ratio explicitly; consider stronger in-flow prompts if ratio stays low	If verified reviews stay below 15% of total reviews at 30 days, revisit how verification is surfaced	Verified Review Rate

F. Dependencies & Future Steps

Dependencies

- Open Questions
 - What counts as a “trusted reviewer” beyond 15 verified reviews, does volume alone justify the badge, or should quality/consistency factor in later?
 - What minimum legibility standard should a receipt meet to count as verified?
- Infrastructure Requirements
 - Google Calendar API integration (already in use for "Places you may have been")
 - Receipt image upload and storage
 - Verified review counter and badge logic tied to user profiles
- Budget Approvals
 - Calendar API usage costs
 - Engineering bandwidth for verification and badge logic

4. Partner Support
 - Google Calendar API: visit detection
5. Internal Dependencies
 - Design team (Verify Your Visit module, New Review updates, badge states)
 - Engineering team (verification logic, badge tracking, receipt handling)
 - Data team (defining what "verified" means for future reputation scoring)

Future Steps

Phase 2: Reputation and Recognition

Depends on Verified Visit Reviews shipping and producing enough data to act on.

- **Reputation based review sorting.** Surfaces reviews from verified, high volume reviewers higher on a restaurant's page. Needs a defined answer to what makes a reviewer trusted beyond 15 verified reviews.
- **Frequent Reviewers achievements section.** A profile section recognizing users who review often, distinct from the cuisine/map based badges below. Depends on the same open question as reputation sorting, what counts as a trusted or high quality reviewer beyond raw review count.
- **Review Map and cuisine badges.** A collection mechanic, similar to Beli's existing city map, rewarding reviews across different cuisines. Builds directly on the verified review system from Phase 1.
- **Review Unlocked share cards.** A shareable passport-stamp card, reusing Beli's existing New City Unlocked flow, triggered by moments like first-to-review or hitting a review count milestone. Depends on Phase 1's verified reviews existing, since these milestones are only meaningful if tied to a real, verified visit.

Phase 3: AI Summary, Reintroduced

Depends on restaurants reaching sufficient verified review volume, not on Phase 2.

- **AI restaurant summary.** Removed from this phase's scope, not part of the current prototype. Reintroduce once a restaurant has at least 10 verified reviews, using only verified reviews as input, not the full unverified review pool. The goal is trust, not just volume.

Not phased, lowest priority overall

- **Creator or Ambassador Program.** Beli invites reviewers to try new or partner restaurants for free, with a mandatory disclosed review and no payment tied to sentiment. On hold until legal review defines disclosure requirements and a compensation structure that doesn't tie payment to review sentiment. No target phase until that review is complete.